Sous Vide Tuna

Seafood | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: sous-vide bath, food-safe bag, and heavy skillet. Plan ahead: refrigerate seasoned tuna 30 minutes to overnight. For the listed 1 1/2-2-inch steaks, the saved cooking chart gives 45-60 minutes; choose temperature using the guide below.

Ingredients

[ ] 2 tuna steaks, 10-12 oz each and about 1 1/2-2 inches thick

[ ] Kosher salt and black pepper

[ ] 2 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil

[ ] Thyme, dill, parsley, shallot, or citrus zest, optional

[ ] 1/2 cup sesame seeds, optional for searing

[ ] 2 Tbsp vegetable oil for searing

Temperature guide

[ ] 105°F: nearly raw, slightly firmed; good chilled

[ ] 110°F: very moist and just firmed; good for searing

[ ] 115°F: meaty and moist; good for searing

[ ] 120°F: firm and relatively dry

[ ] 130°F: canned-tuna-like texture

Method

1. Season and bag

1. Season 2 tuna steaks, **10-12 oz** each and about 1 1/2-2 inches thick, generously with kosher salt and black pepper.

2. Bag in a single layer with **2 Tbsp** extra-virgin olive oil and optional thyme, dill, parsley, shallot, or citrus zest. Refrigerate at least **30 minutes** and up to overnight.

2. Cook

1. Preheat the bath to your chosen temperature from the temperature guide. Use water displacement rather than a strong vacuum if possible, to avoid deforming the tuna.

2. Cook **45-60 minutes** for 1-2-inch-thick steaks. If using steaks 1 inch thick or less, cook **30-45 minutes** instead.

3. Sear

1. Remove tuna and blot very dry. For a seared finish, season with black pepper or coat with optional **1/2 cup** sesame seeds.

2. Heat **2 Tbsp** vegetable oil in a heavy skillet until lightly smoking. Sear **30-45 seconds** per side, then briefly sear the edges.

Notes and variations

Timing clarification: your personal note says 110°F for 40 minutes. The saved source chart gives 45-60 minutes for the listed thicker steaks; the 40-minute note is preserved below as your preference.

Personal note from Recipe Index: cook at 110°F for 40 minutes, sear; maybe 105°F for rarer tuna.

The source specifically recommends 110°F for very moist seared tuna and 105°F for a nearly raw, sashimi-like texture.

Source

Original recipe: https://www.seriouseats.com/sous-vide-tuna-recipe

Archived for personal use; directions have been condensed/paraphrased from the linked source.